

Review Report of manuscript: BLC-2025-10-0208 (IET Blockchain Wiley)
received 27/7/2026

Paper title: Design of a Blockchain-Based Framework for Digital Copyright Protection and Tamper Prevention

Final decision: **Accept with Major Revision**

Main Points of Criticism:

1-There exist enormous systems that use blockchains, especially the idea behind Non-Fungible Tokens (NFTs), to establish copyrights/access rights and/or tamper proof evidence. Hence, for the paper to provide a contribution *from an academic perspective*, as stated in the conclusion, it must compare with other systems in general especially those who hold nearly the same structure of IPFS or claim to have superior performance than it (i.e., not just the base line centralized system). This should have appeared in the manuscript through discussing the limitations, pros & cons of the systems in the related work, and maybe just partially in the experimental results.

2-It is disturbing that the newest reference in the paper is back dated to 2023 (only one in 2025 that I couldn't find; many others have mixed volume no. or year). That's why I did not trace and/or double check all the cited references introducing a similar structure and left this step to the next round when the authors update their references (they could still keep the older ones as the basis of the new work).

-Is there some mistake and this is an old paper since it is named 2025-10-0208, does this mean it was submitted October 2025 nearly a year ago????

Broader Survey of Related Work:

Since I have been familiar in an earlier work of mine with some of those links, I provide them to the authors to write a more insightful introduction and detailed discussion and comparisons of related work. **The authors are not obligated to use these exact references, or to go deeper in comparing all the design decisions in the same work; naturally, they should cover all in a moderate level of detail and then go deeper on comparing and discussing 1 or 2 dimensions.**

1-Can't be evil NFT license: <https://a16zcrypto.com/posts/article/introducing-nft-licenses>

2-Sony tamper proof of photos using C2PA; my first read about it was about its use in news war pictures by BBC to prove the correct time, location, and that pictures were not edited (can't find this link now).

<https://authenticity.sony.net/camera/en-us/>

<https://www.scanmyphotos.com/blog/2025/10/sony-photo-authenticity-trust.html>

Other companies and a general discussion:

https://www.reddit.com/r/artificial/comments/1902sfz/new_tech_from_camera_makers_tries_to_prove_photos/

The system (updated in 2026 to include videos too:

<https://www.newsshooter.com/2026/03/12/sonys-camera-authenticity-solution-now-supports-video/>) does not involve blockchains or storage management, which means it could be a drop-in replacement for your tamper-proof module (i.e., generalize your work more by saying that SHA256 hash is what you used in the code, but any tamper proof module could work for your system with examples that you can choose from those or come up with your own)

3-In the same direction (enhancing the tamper-proof method) but follows a similar architecture of IPFS + blockchains) is this ACM 2024 paper: “An Intellectual Property Protection Platform Based on Blockchain Technology”; <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3689236.3689267>

4-This one also, IEEE 2024, deploys almost the same architecture: “Implementation of Blockchain and IPFS to safeguard evidentiary data”; <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/10616708>

(the authors must clarify in clear words what distinguish their work from previous work deploying similar architecture)

5-This paper on the other hand, IEEE 2024, claims to provide better performance than systems deploying IPFS which deserves at least a comment if not a detailed discussion and/or analysis (like its authors did in their related work section): “Blockchain-Based Decentralized Storage Design for Data Confidence Over Cloud-Native Edge Infrastructure”; <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/stamp/stamp.jsp?arnumber=10485283>.

6- The same argument applies to this one, MDPI 2024, too:” Blockchain and Smart Contracts for Digital Copyright Protection”; <https://www.mdpi.com/1999-5903/16/5/169>

7-This one could be added to ref. [4] as a newer work, 2024, in the same direction: “A Copyright-Preserving and Fair Image Trading Scheme Based on Blockchain”; https://www.sciopen.com/local/article_pdf/10.26599/TST.2022.9010066.pdf

8-This one, BRICS law journal 2025: “Smart Contracts and Copyright Management: A Significant Change in Intellectual Property Rights”; <https://www.bricslawjournal.com/jour/article/view/1436>

9-Also in 2025:

- this one from Rwanda: “Blockchain-Based Copyright Protection System for Digital Content Creators in Rwanda”; <https://edinburgjournals.org/journals/index.php/journal-of-information-technolog/article/download/696/740/2691>
- “Design of a Blockchain-Based Framework For Digital”; https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=5580658
- This one is a preprint but still you may check it out: “Development of Digital Copyright Licensing Frameworks Utilizing Blockchain Technology”; <https://www.preprints.org/manuscript/202504.2238>

10-There are papers in 2026, examples:

- “A Multilayered Blockchain Security Framework for Copyright Protection of NFT-Based Digital Content”; https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-032-16719-4_25
- “NFTWAB: A Decentralized Approach to NFT Image Copyright Protection Using LSB Watermarking, Ethereum, and IPFS”; https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-032-21631-1_23

Writing Comments: (more detailed inside the manuscript)

- 1- A link to the source code should be added.
- 2- Also, a link on MongoDB and brief explanation of the argument behind choosing it should be added (ex: <https://www.oracle.com/in/database/mongodb/>, their official site: <https://www.mongodb.com/resources/products/fundamentals/why-use-mongodb>, or Wikipedia).
- 3- ANOVA
 - (Analysis of Variance) should have been defined before use
 - The whole t-tests and ANOVA part should be separated in a subsection, or at least separate paragraph
 - Should also be backed up with references.
 - **I’m not familiar with ANOVA, but a simple Google search clarified it performs statistical analysis on 3 or more groups of results; here we have only 2 (should have been 3 or more if the authors compared with other existing systems). I do not want to assume the worse that this part is taken from another work who compared 3 or more designs.**
- 4- There appears to be repetition in describing the results figures (in the 2 columns of page 8 in pdf numbered as 7 in manuscript). Also between the introduction and related work section (you tell yourself while reading: I’ve just read that a few lines before); this part of the problem will be solved if the related work is revised to include more in depth analysis and comparison with the proposed system.
- 5- Reference [7] is in volume 83 not 82, Feb 2024 not 2023, (<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11042-024-18514-3>); I could not find reference [29] at all.